PSA 111

INTRODUCTION TO PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION

POSSIBLE EXAMINATION QUESTIONS

Karatina University • First Year • First Semester

Revision question bank based on the six uploaded course documents

Coverage

Administration and organization; administrative theories; principles and functions of public administration; public versus private administration; budgeting and public policy-making; and the role of public administration in transition societies.

How to use this booklet

Practise defining key concepts, explaining points with examples, comparing theories, and evaluating advantages, limitations and impacts. These are practice questions predicted from the supplied notes—not confirmed or leaked examination questions. Exact exam coverage and mark allocation may differ.

UNIT 1: INTRODUCTION, CHARACTERISTICS, IMPORTANCE AND FUNCTIONS OF PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION

Section A — Short-answer questions

1. Define public administration.
2. Distinguish between public administration as an activity and public administration as an academic field.
3. State four characteristics of public administration.
4. Explain what is meant by political neutrality in public administration.
5. List four qualities of a good public administrator.
6. Define public responsibility and explain why records are important in administration.

Section B — Structured and essay questions

7. Discuss the role and importance of public administration in a modern state.
8. Explain how public administration acts as an instrument of social change.
9. Analyse the role of public administration in national integration and continuity of government.
10. Discuss how public administration contributes to identifying and managing national resources.
11. Explain the contribution of public administration to employment creation and the delivery of essential services.
12. ‘Public administration is the machinery through which government policies become practical services.’ Discuss.

UNIT 2: ADMINISTRATION AND ORGANIZATION

Section A — Short-answer questions

13. Define administration according to the ideas presented in the notes.
14. Define organization and explain how it differs from administration.
15. Explain hierarchy, unity of command, chain of command and span of control.
16. What is meant by the functional basis of public administration?
17. Distinguish between centralization and decentralization.
18. Explain the principles of specialization, integration, hierarchy and permanency.

Section B — Structured and essay questions

19. Discuss any four basic characteristics of administration, giving relevant examples.
20. Explain the functional and geographical bases of public administration.

21. Compare centralized and decentralized administrative systems, showing the strengths and limitations of each.
22. Assess the importance of specialization and integration in the achievement of organizational goals.
23. Explain the principle of permanency and its importance when political leaders change.
24. Discuss the principles of political direction, public responsibility, efficiency, organization, public relations, evolution and research in public administration.

UNIT 3: ADMINISTRATIVE THEORIES

Section A — Short-answer questions

25. What is an administrative theory?
26. Identify the main contributors associated with administrative management theory in the notes.
27. Expand POSDCORB and explain any four of its functions.
28. Who is associated with bureaucratic management theory?
29. State four characteristics of Weberian bureaucracy.
30. What is the human relations theory of organization?
31. List Maslow's hierarchy of needs in the order presented in the notes.

Section B — Structured and essay questions

32. Compare administrative management theory, bureaucratic management theory and human relations theory.
33. Discuss the contribution of Henri Fayol, Luther Gulick and Lyndall Urwick to administrative management.
34. Explain Max Weber's main ideas on bureaucracy and assess their relevance to public organizations.
35. Discuss Elton Mayo's contribution to the human relations approach.
36. Explain how motivation and job satisfaction may affect efficiency and productivity in an organization.
37. Evaluate the strengths and limitations of POSDCORB as a guide to the work of an administrator.

UNIT 4: PRINCIPLES OF PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION

Section A — Short-answer questions

38. Define a principle of public administration.

39. Explain the principle of political direction.

40. What is administrative authority? Identify the three sources or forms of authority described in the notes.

41. Explain the principle of efficiency.

42. Why are coordination, correlation and integration important in administration?

43. Explain the principle of research in public administration.

Section B — Structured and essay questions

44. Discuss any six principles of public administration and show their relevance to effective service delivery.

45. Explain the relationship between political leadership and public administration.

46. Analyse why public administrators must be accountable for their decisions and actions.

47. Discuss the importance of public relations in democratic administration.

48. ‘Efficiency should be pursued without neglecting public welfare and responsibility.’ Discuss.

49. Explain how research and continuous improvement can strengthen public administration.

UNIT 5: PUBLIC AND PRIVATE ADMINISTRATION

Section A — Short-answer questions

50. Define private administration.

51. State five similarities between public and private administration.

52. Explain the principle of uniformity in public administration.

53. How does financial control differ between public and private administration?

54. Explain the meaning of profit motive.

55. Why is performance assessment sometimes difficult in public administration?

Section B — Structured and essay questions

56. Evaluate the similarities and differences between public administration and private administration.

57. Discuss how public accountability affects the decisions of public administrators.

58. Compare the purposes, funding and financial control of public and private organizations.

59. Explain differences in span of activities, decision-making structures and terms of service.

60. ‘Public administration can learn from private management, but cannot simply copy it.’ Discuss with reference to public welfare and accountability.

61. Explain the concept of ecology of public administration and discuss the economic, social-cultural, political and legal factors that influence administration.

UNIT 6: FACTORS INFLUENCING BUDGETING

Section A — Short-answer questions

62. Define a public budget and explain why budgeting is important to government.
63. Identify four political factors that influence budgeting.
64. Explain how economic growth or recession affects government budgeting.
65. How do taxation and revenue generation influence budget allocations?
66. Explain the influence of constitutional and procurement rules on public budgets.
67. How can population growth and public expectations affect government expenditure?
68. Explain how national debt and deficit management influence budgeting.

Section B — Structured and essay questions

69. Discuss the political, economic, legal and regulatory factors that influence the budgeting process.
70. Analyse the influence of social and demographic factors on public expenditure.
71. Explain how administrative capacity and bureaucratic efficiency affect the preparation and implementation of budgets.
72. Discuss the effects of global economic trends, international aid and donor conditions on national budgets.
73. Evaluate how climate change and technological advancement can alter government budget priorities.
74. ‘A budget is not determined by revenue alone.’ Discuss the different factors that shape public budgeting.

UNIT 7: FACTORS AFFECTING PUBLIC POLICY-MAKING

Section A — Short-answer questions

75. Define public policy and public policy-making.
76. Explain how political ideology and party interests influence policy.
77. How can elections and public opinion affect government policy?
78. Identify four economic factors that influence policy-making.
79. Explain the role of social movements, advocacy groups and lobbying in policy-making.
80. How do constitutional provisions and court decisions influence public policy?

81. Explain the role of data and technology in policy decisions.

Section B — Structured and essay questions

82. Discuss the major political, economic, social-cultural and legal factors affecting public policy-making.

83. Analyse the influence of bureaucracy and administrative capacity on policy formulation and implementation.

84. Explain how international institutions, global events and international agreements can influence domestic policy.

85. Discuss the positive and negative effects of pressure groups and corporate lobbying on policy-making.

86. Explain how crises and emergencies can lead to rapid changes in public policy.

87. Compare the factors that influence public budgeting with those that influence public policy-making.

UNIT 8: PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION IN TRANSITION SOCIETIES

Section A — Short-answer questions

88. What is a transition society?

89. State four roles of public administration in transition societies.

90. Explain institutional rebuilding and strengthening.

91. How does public administration promote the rule of law and good governance during transition?

92. Explain the role of civil society engagement and public accountability.

93. Identify four challenges faced by public administration in transition societies.

Section B — Structured and essay questions

94. Discuss the role of public administration in societies undergoing political, social or economic transition.

95. Explain how public administration contributes to institutional rebuilding and policy implementation in transition societies.

96. Analyse the contribution of public administration to conflict management, peacebuilding and reconciliation.

97. Discuss the role of public administration in promoting social and economic development during transition.

98. Explain why human resource management and capacity building are important in transition societies.

99. Assess the challenges of corruption, institutional weakness, political instability and lack of public trust in transition societies, suggesting ways to address them.

MIXED REVISION: INTEGRATED EXAMINATION PRACTICE

Long-answer practice

100. ‘Public administration is both a process and an instrument of development.’ Discuss.

101. Compare the classical, bureaucratic and human relations approaches, using examples from public organizations.

102. Examine how political, economic, legal, social and technological environments shape administrative decisions.

103. Discuss how public participation, transparency and accountability can improve budgeting and policy implementation.

104. Using examples from the notes, explain how effective administration can support democratic transition and public trust.

105. Assess the extent to which decentralization can improve service delivery while creating coordination challenges.

106. Discuss the relationship between administrative efficiency, ethical conduct and public welfare.

107. Prepare an essay explaining the stages or main influences involved in turning public priorities into budgets, policies and services.

EXAM TECHNIQUE CHECKLIST

- Start each answer with a clear definition when the question asks you to define, explain or discuss a concept.
- For ‘state’ or ‘list’ questions, give concise, distinct points; for ‘explain’ and ‘discuss’, develop each point with a short explanation.
- For ‘compare and contrast’, cover both similarities and differences rather than describing only one side.
- For ‘evaluate’ or ‘assess’, include strengths, limitations and a reasoned conclusion.
- Use examples supplied by your lecture notes where relevant, such as public service delivery, budgeting, decentralization, institutional rebuilding and public accountability.
- Observe command words, marks and any instruction to answer a specified number of questions.

Source note: This question bank was prepared from the six PDFs supplied in this chat. It reorganizes and turns their concepts, headings and revision prompts into practice questions. It is not an official Karatina University examination paper.